ONI DOJO 鬼道場

N3

JLPT N3 Workbook

The bridge to real Japanese

Nuance, explanations, passive and causative, and the grammar of news, notices and conversation.

30	89	384	12	813
LESSONS	GRAMMAR POINTS	WORDS	READINGS	EXERCISES

with Kurenai 紅 · Slettvold Security · slettvold.org

How to use this workbook

> *“Welcome to my dojo. I am Kurenai, your sensei, and yes, I am an oni. Don't worry, I only bite lazy students. Work through one lesson at a time, write your answers by hand, and check them at the back. Then do it again in a week. That's the whole secret.”*

1. **Read the grammar.** Each point has a short explanation and examples. Read the examples aloud.
2. **Learn the words.** Tick the box when you know a word without looking.
3. **Read the dialogue** and cover the English to see how much you understand.
4. **Do the practice** on paper without looking back, then check your answers in the answer key.
5. **Read the stories** placed between the lessons. They only use what you have learned so far.
6. **Review.** Come back to a lesson after a few days and a week. Spaced review is what makes words stick.

Furigana (small kana above kanji) is shown in grammar, dialogues and stories. Try reading without it first. In the practice sections there is less help, as in the real test.

This workbook follows the N3 course in the **Oni Dojo** app (slettvold.org/onidojo), where every sentence also has audio, flashcards and typed answers. You can use the book on its own or together with the app.

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N3 · LESSON 1

Trying and refusing ようとする・まい



In this lesson you will

- Describe an attempt with 〜ようとする
- Say "be about to" with 〜ようとしたとき
- Express firm will not with 〜まい and 〜ようとしない

Grammar

1 〜ようとする *try to …, be about to …*

Volitional form + とする. It describes an attempt, often one that doesn't succeed: 起きようとしたが、起きられなかった. With とき / ところ it means "just as I was about to": 家を出ようとしたとき、電話が鳴った.

Compare てみる (N4): てみる means trying something out to see what happens; ようとする means making an effort to do it.

何度も思い出そうとしたが、名前が出てこない。	I tried again and again to remember, but the name won't come.
家を出ようとしたとき、雨が降り出した。	Just as I was about to leave the house, it started to rain.
ドアを開けようとしても、開かない。	Even when I try to open the door, it won't open.

2 〜ようとしない *refuse to …, won't …*

Used about other people: they show no intention of doing something. 息子は野菜を食べようとしない "My son won't eat vegetables". For yourself, use 〜つもりはない.

弟は何度言っても、謝ろうとしない。	No matter how many times I tell him, my brother refuses to apologise.
彼は人の意見を聞こうとしない。	He won't listen to other people's opinions.

3 〜まい *will not (firm resolve) / probably not*

A written, slightly old-fashioned negative will: dictionary form + まい (group 2 verbs also ます-stem + まい: 食べまい; する → するまい/しまい). 二度と遅刻するまい "I will never be late again".

It can also guess a negative: 彼は来るまい "he probably won't come" — in speech, ないだろう is more common.

もう二度とあの店には行くまいと決めた。	I decided I would never go to that shop again.
こんな失敗は二度とするまい。	I will never make a mistake like this again.

Vocabulary

	WORD	READING	MEANING	✓
	思い出す	おもいだす	remember, recall	☐
	鳴る	なる	ring, sound	☐
	謝る	あやまる	apologise	☐
	二度と	にどと	never again (with neg.)	☐
	遅刻	ちこく	being late	☐
	失敗	しっぱい	failure, mistake	☐
	努力	どりょく	effort	☐
	無理に	むりに	forcibly	☐
	我慢する	がまんする	endure, hold back	☐
	素直	すなお	honest, obedient	☐
	頑固	がんこ	stubborn	☐
	決心	けっしん	determination	☐
🌧️	**降り出す**	ふりだす	start to rain	☐

Dialogue: The stubborn pupil

A new pupil refuses to practise.

紅 あの新しい弟子、全然練習しようとしないの。

That new pupil won't practise at all.

あなた 話してみましょうか。

Shall I try talking to him?

紅 お願い。昨日、帰ろうとしたところを捕まえて話したんだけど……。

Please. Yesterday I caught him just as he was about to go home and talked to him, but…

あなた 僕も最初は漢字を覚えようとしませんでしたよ。

At first I didn't try to learn kanji either.

紅 そうだったわね。でも、あなたは「もう諦めまい」って言ったじゃない。

That's right. But you said, "I won't give up anymore."

あなた 先生がこわかったからです。

That was because you were scary.

Kurenai's culture corner

N3 is the "bridge" level: the JLPT describes it as understanding everyday Japanese "to a certain degree". It's where textbook Japanese starts meeting real Japanese — newspaper headlines, casual speech, and the emotional nuance of grammar like ようとしない.

Practice

1.1 Match the word to its meaning

Match each Japanese word with its English meaning.

1. _____ 二度と
2. _____ 降り出す
3. _____ 頑固
4. _____ 鳴る
5. _____ 意見
6. _____ 決心
7. _____ 我慢する
8. _____ 無理に
9. _____ 思い出す
10. _____ 失敗

a forcibly
b remember, recall
c ring, sound
d failure, mistake
e never again (with neg.)
f opinion
g stubborn
h start to rain 🌧️
i determination
j endure, hold back

1.2 Choose the right word

Choose the word that fills the blank ____.

1. 家を出____としたとき、雨が降り出した。 (Just as I was about to leave, it rained.)

   a ない **b** る **c** よう **d** た

2. 何度も思い出____としたが、だめだった。 (I tried to remember, but couldn't.)

   a す **b** せ **c** そう **d** し

3. 弟は謝ろうと____。 (My brother refuses to apologise.)

   a いない **b** しない **c** ならない **d** できない

4. 二度とあの店には行く____。 (I will never go to that shop again.)

   a ず **b** ない **c** よう **d** まい

5. こんな失敗は二度と____まい。 (I will never make such a mistake again.)

   a し **b** さ **c** する **d** せ

6. 彼は人の意見を聞こう____しない。 (He won't listen to others.)

   a を **b** と **c** に **d** が

1.3 Translate into Japanese

Write each sentence in Japanese (kana is fine), then check against the model answer.

1. Just as I was about to leave, the phone rang.

2. My son won't eat vegetables.

3. I tried to remember his name.

4. I will never be late again.

1.4 Understand the dialogue

Match each line from the dialogue to its meaning.

1. _____ あの新しい弟子、全然練習しようとしないの。
2. _____ 話してみましょうか。
3. _____ お願い。昨日、帰ろうとしたところを捕まえて話したんだけど……。
4. _____ 僕も最初は漢字を覚えようとしませんでしたよ。
5. _____ そうだったわね。でも、あなたは「もう諦めまい」って言ったじゃない。
6. _____ 先生がこわかったからです。

a At first I didn't try to learn kanji either.

b Shall I try talking to him?

c That's right. But you said, "I won't give up anymore."

d That new pupil won't practise at all.

e Please. Yesterday I caught him just as he was about to go home and talked to him, but…

f That was because you were scary.

N3 · LESSON 2

The logic of わけ わけだ・わけではない・わけにはいかない

In this lesson you will

- Draw conclusions with ～わけだ
- Soften statements with ～わけではない
- Say "can't possibly" with ～わけがない and ～わけにはいかない

Grammar

1 ～わけだ *so that's why / no wonder / that means …*

わけ means "reason, logic". ～わけだ states a natural conclusion from facts: 十年もアメリカに住んでいたんですか。英語が上手なわけですね "No wonder your English is good". Nouns take な/の: 学生なわけだ.

三時間も歩いたのか。疲れたわけだ。	You walked for three hours? No wonder you're tired.
一日五時間勉強している。上手になるわけだ。	She studies five hours a day. Naturally she's improving.
つまり、明日は休みというわけですね。	So, that means tomorrow is a day off.

2 ～わけではない *it's not that …, not necessarily*

A partial denial — it avoids sounding absolute: 嫌いなわけではない "It's not that I dislike it". With 全部/いつも/必ず it means "not all / not always": 日本人がみんな寿司が好きなわけではない.

肉が嫌いなわけではないが、あまり食べない。	It's not that I dislike meat, but I don't eat much.
高いものがいつもいいわけではない。	Expensive things aren't always good.

3 ～わけがない／～わけにはいかない *there's no way … / I can't (because of duty)*

わけがない (= はずがない) denies something strongly: あの人がうそをつくわけがない "There's no way he'd lie".

わけにはいかない means you can't do something because of social or moral reasons, even if you physically could: 明日は試験だから、遊びに行くわけにはいかない. ない form + わけにはいかない = "have to": 行かないわけにはいかない "I can't not go".

こんな簡単な問題がわからないわけがない。	There's no way you don't understand such an easy question.
大事な会議があるので、休むわけにはいかない。	There's an important meeting, so I can't take the day off.
先生に頼まれたら、断るわけにはいかない。	If Sensei asks, I can't refuse.
友だちの結婚式だから、行かないわけにはいかない。	It's my friend's wedding, so I have to go.

Vocabulary

WORD	READING	MEANING	✓
わけ		reason, meaning	☐
つまり		in other words	☐
必ず	かならず	certainly, always	☐
断る	ことわる	refuse, decline	☐
うそをつく		tell a lie	☐
大事	だいじ	important	☐
当然	とうぜん	natural, of course	☐
結論	けつろん	conclusion	☐
理解	りかい	understanding	☐
責任	せきにん	responsibility	☐
義理	ぎり	social obligation	☐
簡単	かんたん	simple	☐
嫌う	きらう	dislike	☐
いつも		always	☐

Dialogue: Obligation chocolate

It's February 14th at the office.

あなた 先生(せんせい)、どうしてチョコを二十個(にじゅっこ)も買(か)ったんですか。

Sensei, why did you buy twenty chocolates?

紅 義理(ぎり)チョコよ。神社(じんじゃ)の神様(かみさま)たちに渡(わた)さないわけにはいかないの。

Obligation chocolate. I can't not give some to the shrine gods.

あなた じゃあ、全部好(ぜんぶす)きな人(ひと)にあげるわけじゃないんですね。

So it's not that you're giving them all to people you like.

紅 もちろん。本命(ほんめい)は一(ひと)つだけ。

Of course. Only one is the real one.

あなた えっ、誰(だれ)ですか。

What, who?

紅 言(い)うわけがないでしょう。

As if I'd tell you.

Kurenai's culture corner

On Valentine's Day in Japan, women traditionally give chocolate: 本命(ほんめい)チョコ ("true feeling") to a loved one, 義理(ぎり)チョコ ("obligation chocolate") to male colleagues, and 友(とも)チョコ to friends. 義理(ぎり) — social obligation — runs deep in Japanese relationships, and many offices have now banned obligation chocolate.

Practice

2.1 Match the word to its meaning

Match each Japanese word with its English meaning.

1. _____ うそをつく
2. _____ わけ
3. _____ 頼む
4. _____ 当然
5. _____ 義理
6. _____ 大事
7. _____ 簡単
8. _____ つまり
9. _____ いつも
10. _____ 断る

a natural, of course
b simple
c important
d refuse, decline
e ask, request
f in other words
g always
h social obligation
i tell a lie
j reason, meaning

2.2 Choose the right word

Choose the word that fills the blank ____.

1. 三時間(さんじかん)も歩(ある)いたのか。疲(つか)れた____だ。 (No wonder you're tired.)

   a よう **b** はず **c** こと **d** わけ

2. 肉が嫌(きら)いな____ではない。 (It's not that I dislike meat.)

   a わけ **b** はず **c** の **d** もの

3. あの人(ひと)がうそをつく____がない。 (There's no way he'd lie.)

   a ため **b** もの **c** わけ **d** よう

4. 大事(だいじ)な会議(かいぎ)があるので、休(やす)む____にはいかない。 (I can't take the day off.)

   a わけ **b** こと **c** ため **d** はず

5. 高(たか)いものがいつもいい____ではない。 (Expensive isn't always good.)

   a そう **b** よう **c** わけ **d** はず

6. つまり、明日(あした)は休(やす)みという____ですね。 (So tomorrow is a day off.)

   a わけ **b** つもり **c** はず **d** ため

2.3 Translate into Japanese

Write each sentence in Japanese (kana is fine), then check against the model answer.

1. No wonder you're tired.

2. It's not that I dislike it.

3. I can't take the day off.

4. There's no way he would lie.

2.4 Understand the dialogue

Match each line from the dialogue to its meaning.

1. _____ 先生、どうしてチョコを二十個も買ったんですか。
2. _____ 義理チョコよ。神社の神様たちに渡さないわけにはいかないの。
3. _____ じゃあ、全部好きな人にあげるわけじゃないんですね。
4. _____ もちろん。本命は一つだけ。
5. _____ えっ、誰ですか。
6. _____ 言うわけがないでしょう。

a Obligation chocolate. I can't not give some to the shrine gods.

b What, who?

c So it's not that you're giving them all to people you like.

d Of course. Only one is the real one.

e As if I'd tell you.

f Sensei, why did you buy twenty chocolates?

続く…

That was lessons 1 and 2 of 30 lessons.

“Not bad, pupil. The full JLPT N3 workbook has every lesson, every reading, the complete answer key and the word list. Come and get it, I'll be waiting.” — Kurenai

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